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Compare Claude Code Tools

You

I want a better way to use Claude Code. I'm working on multiple projects, and I have too many terminals open. I need one piece of software that is organizing all my multiple Claude Code sessions. I am fine with using niche apps made by new devs also. I'm willing to try stuff off of GitHub. Find me the best options.

Worked for 1m 8s >

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My picks for your situation: cmux if you use a Mac, Claudes if you want a desktop app on Windows, and Agent Deck if you're happy staying in one terminal. All three directly address managing sessions across projects.

I checked current project documentation as of **November 11, 2026**. These are researched recommendations; I haven't personally tested the apps.

Option	Best fit	Platforms	Why it makes the shortlist	Main tradeoff
cmux	Keeping your familiar Claude Code workflow organized	macOS	Project workspaces, vertical tabs, splits, and an attention panel. Sidebar shows directory, branch, PR, ports, and notifications; panes light up when an agent needs you.	Mac only; primarily a terminal with organization tools.
Claudes	A dedicated Claude Code desktop dashboard	Windows, macOS, Linux	Groups sessions by **project → workspace → terminal columns**. Includes activity indicators, transcript search, context meters, usage tracking, and session resume.	Tiny personal project; free to use, but its license restricts modification and redistribution.
Agent Deck	Managing lots of sessions from one terminal	macOS, Linux, Windows through WSL	Groups, global search, running/waiting/done status, session forking, worktrees, and cost tracking. Also has a local web interface.	More keyboard-oriented, with more features to learn.
Paradev, formerly Superset	Running parallel development tasks and reviewing their changes	macOS; experimental Linux; no Windows desktop	Separate worktree per task, persistent terminals, agent status, diff review, PR tools, and browser previews in one app.	A bigger workflow change if you only want to organize existing sessions.
CCManager	A relatively straightforward terminal session manager	Terminal app; check environment compatibility	Multiple repositories in one interface, busy/waiting/idle indicators, restart restoration, and worktree management—with no tmux dependency.	Less visual than a desktop dashboard.

The capabilities and platform details above come from the projects' own documentation. GitHub +6

How I'd choose between them

1. Try cmux first on a Mac.
Your complaint is "too many terminals across multiple projects," and cmux's sidebar and attention system are particularly well matched to that. You keep using real terminal Claude Code sessions, with a clearer overview of where everything lives and which session needs a response. It's built natively with Swift/AppKit and Ghostty's terminal engine. GitHub

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2. Try Claudes first for a Windows desktop app.
This is the most directly matched niche find: its developer explicitly built it after getting tired of juggling Claude Code terminal windows. Project grouping, named workspaces, side-by-side sessions, and search across past transcripts cover your request unusually closely. **I'd treat it as a promising trial rather than a proven default**, given its small adoption. Download an installer from its releases page; Claude Code must already be installed. GitHub +1

3. Choose Agent Deck if one organized terminal sounds ideal.
It has the strongest combination here of session grouping, search, status visibility, and tools for managing a growing collection of agents. On Windows it runs through WSL. It's free under the MIT license. GitHub +1

4. Choose Paradev if you also want parallel branches and code review.
This is my pick when the problem includes several agents changing the same repository. Each task gets its own working directory and branch, with review tools alongside the terminals. Its free plan includes unlimited local projects and workspaces for one user; Pro adds remote access and automations at $20/month, or $16/month billed annually. github.com +1

Another small project worth watching is Herd: a compact terminal manager that automatically groups sessions by Git repository, shows attention states, and includes project-specific shells and optional worktrees. It uses tmux underneath and currently has very little adoption, so I'd try Agent Deck before it. GitHub

A few names you'll encounter in older recommendations need context:

- **Conductor:** I wouldn't start a new setup with it now. Its official announcement says it is winding down after joining Meta; cloud service shuts down November 20, with local fixes continuing until early 2027. Conductor Chan...
- **Vibe Kanban:** Still available, but its company shut down and the project is transitioning to community maintenance. vibekanban.com
- **Emdash Classic:** A worthwhile cross-platform alternative with parallel worktrees, but its website says it now receives fixes while new development has moved to Emdash 2.0. emdash.com +1

For your first trial, I'd spend one working session with cmux on Mac or Claudes on Windows. If you prefer keyboard navigation and WSL/Linux, start with Agent Deck. Those choices most closely target the organization problem you described.

You

I have heard about one more. It's called afterterm, I think. Can you check it and compare it against the rest?

Worked for 32s >

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Yes—you mean Afterterm. **If you're on Windows, I'd put it near the top of your shortlist for the exact problem you described.** I missed it in my first search.

Its design is particularly relevant: projects contain Claude Code conversations and regular shells, with a dashboard showing what needs attention. It's free under the MIT license, Windows only, and currently an early `0.x` project. This assessment is based on its documentation, rather than hands-on testing. GitHub

What makes Afterterm stand out

- **Organization around projects:** named projects with colours, icons, pinned cards, and their associated conversations and shells.
- **Persistent attention indicators:** a session's "needs you" indicator remains until you respond, even after you've viewed it.
- **Sleep and resume:** reopening the app restores saved output; conversations resume through `claude --resume` when you wake them.
- **Dev-server awareness:** detects listening ports, offers localhost links, and can rerun the server command.
- **Windows shell integration:** supports PowerShell, Command Prompt, Git Bash, and WSL. GitHub

One distinction matters: **restoring a conversation is different from keeping its process running.** Afterterm documents restoring threads asleep and resuming them on demand; don't assume agents continue working after the app closes. GitHub

Compared with	Where I'd favour Afterterm	Where I'd favour the alternative
Claudes	Your priority is moving between projects and spotting sessions that need you.	You want a tiled grid of agents, transcript-wide search, context meters, usage analytics, and prompt broadcasting.
cmux	You use Windows and want dedicated Claude session organization.	You use macOS and want a native terminal with splits, notifications, SSH, and an integrated browser.

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Compared with	Where I'd favour Afterterm	Where I'd favour the alternative
Agent Deck	You prefer a desktop interface with project cards and familiar Windows shells.	You want keyboard-driven fleet management, session forking, cost tracking, and support for several agent tools.
Paradev / Superset	You mainly need to organize conversations across existing project folders.	You want a separate Git worktree per task, integrated diff/PR review, and browser previews.
CCManager	You want a more visual desktop experience.	You want a compact terminal interface for multiple repositories, session states, and creating or merging worktrees.
Emdash Classic	You want a Windows-focused session organizer.	You want a cross-platform desktop app built around parallel tasks in separate worktrees.

Those comparisons reflect the documented capabilities of each app; the preference judgments are mine. github.com +5

The main tradeoff is maturity. Afterterm explicitly describes itself as early and occasionally rough, and its Windows installer is currently unsigned. There's limited evidence to judge reliability at scale. Its MIT license is more permissive than Claudes' license, which allows free use but restricts modification and redistribution. GitHub +1

My updated recommendation: on Windows, I'd **try Afterterm first for your organization problem**, then Claudes if you find you want more simultaneous panes and analytics. On Mac, cmux remains my first pick. For Linux or a terminal-focused WSL workflow, I'd choose Agent Deck.

You can find Afterterm's installer on its GitHub releases page.

You

Why didn't this show up in your earlier research?

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Because my first search wasn't thorough enough to justify calling the results the "best options."

Afterterm didn't appear in the broad searches I ran. I followed the tools those searches surfaced, then stopped without checking further for smaller Windows-focused projects—even though you explicitly welcomed niche GitHub apps.

I can't establish why the search engine didn't surface it. Its small footprint may contribute, but that's speculation. The mistake on my side was presenting a confident shortlist without making that coverage limitation clear. Afterterm deserved consideration because its documented purpose closely matches your request.

You

What are the search queries that you ran?

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These were the exact search queries I ran for the **original shortlist**, in order:

1. `Claude Code multiple sessions manager GUI terminal GitHub`
2. `Claude Code session manager Crystal Vibe Kanban Claude Squad`
3. `cmux Superset Emdash Claude Code GitHub multiple projects`
4. `Conductor Claude Code Mac Windows pricing runconductor`
5. `Vibe Kanban winding down GitHub`
6. `GitHub kbwo ccmanager agent-deck claude-squad`
7. `Superset pricing Windows Linux official`

Queries 3–5 used a **90-day recency filter**. I also opened project repositories, official websites, pricing pages, and documentation directly.

After you mentioned Afterterm, I searched:

1. `Afterterm Claude Code session manager GitHub`
2. `site:github.com/afteraryan/afterterm/releases afterterm`
3. `site:github.com/afteraryan/afterterm "worktree" "split"`

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The gap is visible here: my initial searches quickly became focused on names I had already found. I never ran a broader query such as `Windows Claude Code multi-project session manager GitHub`.

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